

RSP3 in MESA/star

Local Entropy Moments in RSP2

2026-09-20

1 Scope and variables

RSP3 denotes the optional three equation convection model within RSP2. It evolves turbulent kinetic energy, entropy flux and entropy variance. The existing independent superadiabaticity and luminosity equations remain. The mode is selected in `&controls`:

```
RSP2_use_3equation_model = .true.  
RSP2_alfa_pi = 1d0  
RSP2_alfa_phi = 1d0
```

RSP2 itself must already be enabled. The new mode defaults to false. There is no separate RSP3 solver or `star_job` action.

Variable	Location	Definition and role
w	Face	$e_t = w^2 = \frac{1}{2}\langle \mathbf{v}' ^2 \rangle$; $w \geq 0$, in cm s^{-1} .
Π (Pi)	Face	$\langle v'_r s' \rangle$, signed entropy flux, in $\text{erg cm g}^{-1} \text{K}^{-1} \text{s}^{-1}$.
Φ (Phi)	Face	$\langle s'^2 \rangle$, full nonnegative entropy variance, in $\text{erg}^2 \text{g}^{-2} \text{K}^{-2}$.
Y	Face	$\nabla_T - \nabla_L$, signed independent solver variable.
L	Face	Total luminosity, in erg s^{-1} .
v or u	Face or cell	Mean radial velocity; distinct from turbulent w .

Specific entropy is s . Thermodynamic derivatives are $\chi_\rho = (\partial \ln P / \partial \ln \rho)_T$ and $\chi_T = (\partial \ln P / \partial \ln T)_\rho$. The full variance here is twice the Φ used by Flaskamp and Braun et al. The old `PII` has entropy units and factors out turbulent velocity; it is not the new `II`.

MESA indexes inward: cell k lies between faces k and $k + 1$. The turbulent variables share face control volumes:

$$e_{t,f} = w_f^2, \quad e_{t,c,k} = \frac{1}{2}(w_k^2 + w_{k+1}^2), \quad \Delta m_{f,k} = \frac{1}{2}(\Delta m_{k-1} + \Delta m_k). \quad (1.1)$$

The surface volume has mass $\Delta m_1/2$. The mathematical inner face $N + 1$ has $w = \Pi = \Phi = 0$ and mass $\Delta m_N/2$. Thus $\sum_k \Delta m_k e_{t,c,k} = \sum_f \Delta m_f w_f^2$ exactly. Thermodynamic face values retain the selected reconstruction or RSP2 weights $a_f = \Delta m_{k-1}/(\Delta m_{k-1} + \Delta m_k)$, or $1/2$. These weights do not average the independent face turbulent variables.

Blue boxes contain time dependent rows. **Brown boxes** contain algebraic rows. Unboxed formulas define their coefficients, discretization and scaling. The physical rows are followed by their residuals and static linearizations. Perturbations vary as $\exp(\sigma t)$; positive $\Re(\sigma)$ means growth.

2 Face turbulent energy

Both RSP2 and RSP3 evolve face w . In RSP3 the buoyant source is local to Pi and the direct radiative sink D_r is absent. Write the face pressure work increment as

$$W_{f,k} = \frac{\alpha_p}{3\Delta m_{f,k}} \sum_{j=k-1,k} \Delta m_j [\theta_P \rho_j w_k^2 + (1 - \theta_P) \rho_{j,0} w_{k,0}^2] (\rho_j^{-1} - \rho_{j,0}^{-1}). \quad (2.1)$$

Here 0 denotes accepted state and $\alpha_p = \text{RSP2_alfap}$. Forced faces have $W_f = 0$.

Turbulent energy and finite timestep residual

$$\frac{d(w_k^2)}{dt} + \dot{W}_{f,k} = -\frac{L_{t,c,k-1} - L_{t,c,k}}{\Delta m_{f,k}} + S_k - D_k + Eq_{f,k}, \quad (2.2)$$

$$R_{E,k} = (w_k - w_{k,0})(w_k + w_{k,0}) + W_{f,k} + \Delta t \left[\frac{L_{t,c,k-1}^\theta - L_{t,c,k}^\theta}{\Delta m_{f,k}} - S_k + D_k - Eq_{f,k} \right] = 0. \quad (2.3)$$

Static linearization.

On a static background $\delta E q = 0$:

$$\sigma \left[2w_k \delta w_k - \frac{\alpha_p w_k^2}{3\Delta m_{f,k}} \sum_{j=k-1,k} \Delta m_j \delta \ln \rho_j \right] = -\frac{\delta L_{t,c,k-1} - \delta L_{t,c,k}}{\Delta m_{f,k}} + \delta S_k - \delta D_k. \quad (2.4)$$

The superscript θ retains the existing pressure and luminosity time weights. Sources, damping and viscosity retain current-state derivatives. The continuous $\dot{W}_f$ is the limit of equation (2.1). LNA puts its density derivative in the inertia matrix.

The cell turbulent pressure and face dissipation are

$$P_{t,c,k} = \frac{2}{3} \alpha_p \rho_k e_{t,c,k}, \quad D_f = \text{RSP2_alfad} \frac{8}{3} \sqrt{\frac{2}{3}} \frac{w_f^3}{\Lambda_f}. \quad (2.5)$$

Turbulent transport crosses gas cell centers between face volumes:

$$L_{t,c,k} = -\alpha_t \mathcal{A}_{c,k}^2 \rho_k^2 \Lambda_{c,k} \frac{w_k + w_{k+1}}{2} \frac{w_k^2 - w_{k+1}^2}{\Delta m_k}, \quad (2.6)$$

$$L_{t,f,k} = \frac{\Delta m_k L_{t,c,k-1} + \Delta m_{k-1} L_{t,c,k}}{\Delta m_{k-1} + \Delta m_k}. \quad (2.7)$$

Here $r_c^3 = (r_k^3 + r_{k+1}^3)/2$, $\mathcal{A}_c = 4\pi r_c^2$ and $\alpha_t = \text{RSP2_alfat}$. The second expression is the gas-face L_t used in the luminosity equation and profile output. Its divergence is the half sum of adjacent face-energy divergences. Transport is zero across a forced moment boundary, at the surface and at the physical inner boundary.

The face pressure acceleration and source are

$$\left(-\frac{\partial_r P}{\rho} \right)_f = \frac{\mathcal{A}_f (P_k - P_{k-1})}{\Delta m_{f,k}}, \quad S_f = \left(-\frac{\partial_r P}{\rho} \right)_f \frac{\chi_{T,f}}{\chi_{\rho,f} C_{P,f}} \Pi_f. \quad (2.8)$$

There is no cell/face correlation reconstruction. Neighboring Pi values cannot cancel through an average before entering their energy equations. This placement does not alter the physical moment closure or guarantee that it preserves the covariance bound.

3 Face entropy flux

The covariance $\Pi = \langle v'_r s' \rangle$ already includes velocity. Its evolution contains entropy gradient driving, buoyancy acting on entropy variance, turnover relaxation, radiative cooling and mean radial strain:

Entropy flux

$$\begin{aligned} \dot{\Pi}_f = & \frac{2}{3} e_{t,f} (-\partial_r s)_f + \left(-\frac{\partial_r P}{\rho} \right)_f \frac{\chi_{T,f}}{\chi_{\rho,f} C_{P,f}} \Phi_f \\ & - \left(\alpha_{\Pi} \frac{\sqrt{e_{t,f}}}{\Lambda_f} + \tau_{\text{rad},f}^{-1} + (\partial_r v_{\text{rad}})_f \right) \Pi_f. \end{aligned} \quad (3.1)$$

The row actually solved is

$$\begin{aligned} R_{\Pi,f} = & \frac{1}{\Pi_{\text{scale},f}} \left\{ \Pi_f - \Pi_{f,\text{start}} - \Delta t \left[\frac{2}{3} e_{t,f} (-\partial_r s)_f + \left(-\frac{\partial_r P}{\rho} \right)_f \frac{\chi_{T,f}}{\chi_{\rho,f} C_{P,f}} \Phi_f \right. \right. \\ & \left. \left. - \left(\alpha_{\Pi} \frac{\sqrt{e_{t,f}}}{\Lambda_f} + \tau_{\text{rad},f}^{-1} + (\partial_r v_{\text{rad}})_f \right) \Pi_f \right] \right\} = 0. \end{aligned} \quad (3.2)$$

Static linearization.

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma \delta \Pi_f = & \frac{2}{3} [(-\partial_r s)_f \delta e_{t,f} + e_{t,f} \delta (-\partial_r s)_f] \\ & + \left(-\frac{\partial_r P}{\rho} \right)_f \frac{\chi_{T,f}}{\chi_{\rho,f} C_{P,f}} \delta \Phi_f + \Phi_f \delta \left[\left(-\frac{\partial_r P}{\rho} \right) \frac{\chi_T}{\chi_{\rho} C_P} \right]_f \\ & - \left(\alpha_{\Pi} \frac{\sqrt{e_{t,f}}}{\Lambda_f} + \tau_{\text{rad},f}^{-1} \right) \delta \Pi_f \\ & - \Pi_f \delta \left[\alpha_{\Pi} \frac{\sqrt{e_{t,f}}}{\Lambda_f} + \tau_{\text{rad},f}^{-1} + (\partial_r v_{\text{rad}})_f \right]. \end{aligned} \quad (3.3)$$

The static mean strain is zero, but its perturbation remains. For the two velocity grids, the implemented face strain is

$$(\partial_r u)_f = \frac{\mathcal{A}_f \rho_f}{\Delta m_{c,f}} (u_{k-1} - u_k), \quad \text{u_flag}, \quad (3.4)$$

$$(\partial_r v)_f = a_f \frac{v_k - v_{k+1}}{r_k - r_{k+1}} + (1 - a_f) \frac{v_{k-1} - v_k}{r_{k-1} - r_k}, \quad \text{v_flag}. \quad (3.5)$$

The face velocity expression reproduces an affine radial velocity on an unequal grid. The strain term is a deformation of the covariance; it introduces no new eddy viscosity coefficient.

At fixed mass weights, $\delta e_{t,f} = 2a_f w_k \delta w_k + 2(1 - a_f) w_{k-1} \delta w_{k-1}$. The Jacobian retains derivatives of face EOS, pressure differences, mixing length and entropy driving. The accepted state and row scale are held fixed in a Newton solve.

Source: `hydro_rsp2:rsp2_moment_rhs, rsp2_buoyancy_face, do1_rsp2_moment_eqns.`

4 Face entropy variance and coefficients

Full entropy variance

$$\dot{\Phi}_f = 2(-\partial_r s)_f \Pi_f - \left(\alpha_\Phi \frac{\sqrt{e_{t,f}}}{\Lambda_f} + 2\tau_{\text{rad},f}^{-1} \right) \Phi_f, \quad (4.1)$$

$$R_{\Phi,f} = \frac{\Phi_f - \Phi_{f,\text{start}} - \Delta t \left[2(-\partial_r s)_f \Pi_f - \left(\alpha_\Phi \frac{\sqrt{e_{t,f}}}{\Lambda_f} + 2\tau_{\text{rad},f}^{-1} \right) \Phi_f \right]}{\Phi_{\text{scale},f}} = 0. \quad (4.2)$$

Static linearization.

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma \delta \Phi_f &= 2(-\partial_r s)_f \delta \Pi_f + 2\Pi_f \delta(-\partial_r s)_f \\ &\quad - \left(\alpha_\Phi \frac{\sqrt{e_{t,f}}}{\Lambda_f} + 2\tau_{\text{rad},f}^{-1} \right) \delta \Phi_f \\ &\quad - \Phi_f \delta \left[\alpha_\Phi \frac{\sqrt{e_{t,f}}}{\Lambda_f} + 2\tau_{\text{rad},f}^{-1} \right]. \end{aligned} \quad (4.3)$$

There is no spatial transport term in either moment equation. Nonzero `RSP2_alfat` transports kinetic energy through L_t only. The full variance convention doubles its driving relative to a half variance; it does not change the turnover decay rate.

The radiative rate is

$$\tau_{\text{rad},f}^{-1} = \frac{4\sigma_{\text{SB}}\gamma_r^2 T_f^3}{C_{P,f}\kappa_f \rho_f^2 \Lambda_f^2}, \quad \gamma_r = 2\sqrt{3} \text{RSP2_alfar}. \quad (4.4)$$

Thus `RSP2_alfar` = 0 is permitted. It removes radiative damping of both moments while retaining turnover relaxation. There is no direct D_r in Equation (2.2). The one equation model instead applies $D_r = e_t/\tau_{\text{rad}}$ in cells.

Control	Default	Coefficient in this formulation
<code>RSP2_alfa_pi</code>	1	$\alpha_\Pi = 6\sqrt{2/3} \text{RSP2_alfa_pi}$
<code>RSP2_alfa_phi</code>	1	$\alpha_\Phi = 4\sqrt{2/3} \text{RSP2_alfa_phi}$
<code>RSP2_alfad</code>	1	$C_D = (8/3)\sqrt{2/3} \text{RSP2_alfad}$
<code>RSP2_alfar</code>	0	$\gamma_r = 2\sqrt{3} \text{RSP2_alfar}$
<code>RSP2_alfat</code>	0	$\alpha_\omega = \text{RSP2_alfat}$
<code>RSP2_alfap</code>	0	Multiplier of $(2/3)\rho e_t$
<code>RSP2_alfam</code>	0.25	Existing eddy viscosity coefficient

The unit Pi/Phi controls give the local MLT coefficients listed by Braun et al. [1], $\alpha_\Pi \simeq 4.899$ and $\alpha_\Phi \simeq 3.266$. In their fiducial solar model, $\alpha_\Pi = 2.155$ and $\alpha_\Phi = 2$ multiply spatial transport terms. They are not calibrations of the local decay terms used here. Their case A replaces both closures only in the outer layers and uses $\alpha_\Pi = 2.88$, $\alpha_\Phi = 2$ there; the interior remains nonlocal. Neither case supplies a calibration for this fully local pulsation model. The radiative and kinetic transport normalizations do retain their meanings: $\gamma_r \simeq 3.46$ corresponds to `RSP2_alfar` = 1, and $\alpha_\omega = 0.25$ to `RSP2_alfat` = 0.25. The two moment controls must be finite and positive. The mode requires `RSP2_source_seed` = 0.

5 Luminosity and temperature equations

The new entropy flux sets convective luminosity directly:

$$L_{c,f} = \mathcal{A}_f \rho_f T_f \Pi_f, \quad \delta L_{c,f} = \mathcal{A}_f \rho_f T_f \delta \Pi_f + \Pi_f \delta(\mathcal{A}_f \rho_f T_f), \quad (5.1)$$

$$L_{r,f} = \text{Lrad_coeff}_f (\nabla_{L,f} + Y_f), \quad \text{Lrad_coeff}_f = \mathcal{A}_f \frac{4acT_f^4}{3\kappa_f \rho_f H_{P,f}}. \quad (5.2)$$

Here a is the radiation constant. There is no extra w multiplying Π and no enthalpy flux limiter. L_t is Equation (2.6).

Independent flux balance at interior faces

$$R_{\text{flux},f} = \frac{L_{r,f} + L_{c,f} + L_{t,f} - L_f}{L_{\text{scale},f}} = 0, \quad (5.3)$$

$$0 = \delta L_{r,f} + \delta L_{c,f} + \delta L_{t,f} - \delta L_f, \quad (5.4)$$

$$\delta L_{r,f} = \text{Lrad_coeff}_f (\delta \nabla_{L,f} + \delta Y_f) + (\nabla_{L,f} + Y_f) \delta \text{Lrad_coeff}_f. \quad (5.5)$$

The temperature row is retained in `i_eql`. The separate flux row is `i_rsp2_flux`; it supplies the extra equation for Y . Using Y as a solver variable avoids locally inverting a saturated flux law. It does not by itself prove stability or realizability of the moment closure.

Supported interior temperature residuals

The default QHSE row is

$$R_T = \Delta m_{c,f} \left(\frac{d \ln P}{dm} \right)_{\text{QHSE}} (\nabla_L + Y) - \frac{T_{k-1} - T_k}{T_*} = 0. \quad (5.6)$$

Here $T_* = (\Delta m_{k-1} T_k + \Delta m_k T_{k-1}) / (\Delta m_{k-1} + \Delta m_k)$. The radiation pressure row is, up to its positive start normalization,

$$R_T = -\frac{\Delta m_{T,f} \kappa_{\text{row},f} L_{r,f}}{c \mathcal{A}_f^2 \lambda_f} - (P_{\text{rad},k-1} - P_{\text{rad},k}) = 0, \quad P_{\text{rad}} = \frac{aT^4}{3}. \quad (5.7)$$

The actual logarithmic gradient row is

$$R_T = (\nabla_L + Y)(\ln P_{k-1} - \ln P_k) - (\ln T_{k-1} - \ln T_k) = 0. \quad (5.8)$$

Their linearized rows are $\delta R_T = 0$, with current coefficients, face reconstruction and $\delta \nabla_T = \delta \nabla_L + \delta Y$ differentiated throughout.

In Equation (5.7), $\Delta m_{T,f}$ includes the native boundary spacing choice, κ_{row} the opacity floor, and λ the existing radiative flux factor. This radiation treatment is independent of the removed enthalpy limiter. The QHSE coefficient retains the selected momentum geometry and time weights.

At $k = 1$, the independent flux row sets $Y_1 = 0$. The separate surface temperature or luminosity condition remains; the RSP2 surface option uses $L_1 = f_{\text{surf}} \mathcal{A}_1 c a T_1^4$ with its native area time weight. The nonlinear `constant_L` option replaces the temperature row with $L_k = L_1$ and is excluded from LNA.

6 Entropy driving and dynamic gradL

The moment equations need the thermal entropy differential represented by the selected temperature row. For uniform composition,

$$(-\partial_r s)_f = C_{P,f} [(-\partial_r \ln T)_{\text{row},f} - \nabla_{\text{ad},f} (-\partial_r \ln P)_{\text{actual},f}]. \quad (6.1)$$

Using a logarithmic entropy difference with a nonlogarithmic temperature row would shift the discrete neutral state. The implementation therefore maps the actual row before forming the small superadiabatic difference.

For the QHSE and radiation pressure rows, the two thermal coefficients are

$$(-\partial_r \ln T)_{\nabla_T=1,f} = \begin{cases} -\mathcal{A}_f \rho_f (d \ln P / dm)_{\text{QHSE}} T_*/T_f, & \text{QHSE,} \\ \frac{\rho_f \kappa_{\text{row},f} \text{Lrad_coeff}_f}{4c \mathcal{A}_f \lambda_f P_{\text{rad},f}}, & \text{radiation pressure,} \end{cases} \quad (6.2)$$

$$(-\partial_r \ln P)_{\text{actual},f} = \frac{\mathcal{A}_f \rho_f}{\Delta m_{T,f}} \frac{P_k - P_{k-1}}{P_f}. \quad (6.3)$$

For QHSE, $\Delta m_{T,f} = \Delta m_{c,f}$. The reference pressure differential uses $P_k - P_{k-1}$ when `TDC_use_dynamical_gradL` is true and hydro velocity is active. Otherwise it uses the pressure jump implied by the QHSE momentum coefficient, including its mass and area conventions. Writing that choice explicitly,

$$(-\partial_r \ln P)_{\text{ref},f} = \frac{\mathcal{A}_f \rho_f}{\Delta m_{T,f} P_f} \begin{cases} P_k - P_{k-1}, & \text{dynamic gradL,} \\ \Delta P_{\text{HSE},f}, & \text{static gradL,} \end{cases} \quad (6.4)$$

$$\nabla_{L,f} = (\nabla_{\text{ad},f} + B_f) \frac{(-\partial_r \ln P)_{\text{ref},f}}{(-\partial_r \ln T)_{\nabla_T=1,f}}. \quad (6.5)$$

Here B_f is the existing `gradL_composition_term`, included only for the Ledoux choice. It is held fixed in thermal AD. The evaluated driving is

$$\begin{aligned} (-\partial_r s)_f = C_{P,f} [& (-\partial_r \ln T)_{\nabla_T=1,f} Y_f + B_f (-\partial_r \ln P)_{\text{ref},f} \\ & + \nabla_{\text{ad},f} \{ (-\partial_r \ln P)_{\text{ref},f} - (-\partial_r \ln P)_{\text{actual},f} \}]. \end{aligned} \quad (6.6)$$

The last difference is identically zero in the dynamic branch and is removed algebraically before evaluation. This retains the small Y contribution without subtracting two nearly equal neutral contributions. All structure derivatives remain implicit; this changes no luminosity time weight.

For the logarithmic row, $\nabla_L = \nabla_{\text{ad}} + B$ and

$$(-\partial_r s)_f = C_{P,f} \frac{\mathcal{A}_f \rho_f}{\Delta m_{c,f}} \ln(P_k/P_{k-1}) (Y_f + B_f). \quad (6.7)$$

The logarithm is evaluated using `log1p`. For nonlinear `constant_L`, the code instead uses the measured $C_P \mathcal{A} \rho / \Delta m_{c,f} [(T_k - T_{k-1})/T_f - \nabla_{\text{ad}} (P_k - P_{k-1})/P_f]$. The composition term supplies the existing thermal correction; the model does not evolve composition covariances.

Source: `hydro_gradient_support:get_rsp2_thermal_gradient`. LNA uses the same mapping with instantaneous coefficients.

7 Gas energy and pressure work

Both RSP2 energy forms already include turbulent storage. The moment model changes L_c and S but adds no second gas source $-S + D$. Combining the total and turbulent energy rows recovers that exchange. Let $D_m L = (L_k - L_{k+1})/\Delta m_k$ and let ϵ denote the existing nuclear, neutrino and other heating terms.

The dedt energy row

$$\dot{e}_{\text{eff}} = -D_m L + \epsilon + \epsilon_{\text{visc}} - \mathcal{W}, \quad (7.1)$$

$$R_{\text{dedt}} = \epsilon + \epsilon_{\text{visc}} - D_m L^\theta - \mathcal{W}^\theta - \frac{e_{\text{eff}} - e_{\text{eff,start}}}{\Delta t} = 0, \quad (7.2)$$

$$\sigma \delta e_{\text{eff}} = -D_m \delta L + \delta \epsilon - \delta \mathcal{W} \quad \text{on a static background.} \quad (7.3)$$

In every gas row e_t means $e_{t,c} = \frac{1}{2}(w_k^2 + w_{k+1}^2)$. The work includes the conservative redistribution

$$\mathcal{W}_k \leftarrow \mathcal{W}_k + \frac{\frac{1}{2}(W_{f,k} + W_{f,k+1}) - P_{t,c,k}^\theta \Delta(1/\rho_k)}{\Delta t}. \quad (7.4)$$

Its mass integral is zero. It matches the cell projection of turbulent storage and makes local gas/turbulent work cancel when the rows are combined. Both work forms and `eps_grav` use it. In LNA the added work is a density inertia term, with the same zero integral.

The finite step equation is written before the native row normalization. The work control selects both the pressure work and stored energy:

$$e_{\text{eff}} = e + e_t, \quad \mathcal{W}_{\text{local}} = P_{c,k} \frac{\mathcal{A}_k v_{f,k} - \mathcal{A}_{k+1} v_{f,k+1}}{\Delta m_k}, \quad (7.5)$$

$$e_{\text{eff}} = e + e_t + K + E_{\text{grav}}, \quad \mathcal{W}_{\text{flux}} = \frac{P_{f,k} \mathcal{A}_k v_{f,k} - P_{f,k+1} \mathcal{A}_{k+1} v_{f,k+1}}{\Delta m_k}. \quad (7.6)$$

Equation (7.5) applies when `use_P_d_1_div_rho_form_of_work` is true. Equation (7.6) applies when it is false. P_c and P_f are the native work pressures including selected turbulent pressure. With `u_flag`, v_f is the differentiated Riemann contact velocity and P_f is the corresponding work pressure; with `v_flag`, v_f is the stored face velocity. The native discrete K and E_{grav} are retained.

Grid	Local work: ϵ_{visc}	Flux work: ϵ_{visc}
v	Eq_k	$Eq_k + \frac{1}{2}(\bar{v}_k U q_k + \bar{v}_{k+1} U q_{k+1})$
u	Eq_k	$Eq_k + \bar{u}_k U q_k$

Bars denote accepted/current averages. The nonlinear v power retains the cell mass correction when selected. These viscous powers are second order about a static model.

The RSP2 eps_grav energy row

$$R_{\epsilon_{\text{grav}}} = \epsilon + \epsilon_{\text{grav}} + Eq - D_m L^\theta - \mathcal{W}_{\text{-EOS}}^\theta - \frac{e_t - e_{t,\text{start}}}{\Delta t} = 0, \quad (7.7)$$

$$\mathcal{W}_{\text{-EOS}} = (P_c - P_{\text{EOS}}) \frac{\mathcal{A}_k v_{f,k} - \mathcal{A}_{k+1} v_{f,k+1}}{\Delta m_k}. \quad (7.8)$$

This option always uses local work, with no explicit K , E_{grav} or vUq storage/power branch. At fixed composition and consistent EOS, $\epsilon_{\text{grav}} = -\dot{e} - P_{\text{EOS}} d(1/\rho)/dt$. Its static inertia, for the ordinary thermal coefficients, is $\delta e_{t,c} + TCP[(1 - \nabla_{\text{ad}} \chi_T) \delta \ln T - \nabla_{\text{ad}} \chi_\rho \delta \ln \rho]$. Native latent heat, entropy blending and energy factors retain their existing treatment. Adding EOS pressure work again would double count it.

8 Eddy viscosity on the two velocity grids

The new moment rows retain the RSP2 Eq and Uq discretization. TDC keeps separate hydro viscosity routines. Both models now use a face turbulent velocity and the same spatial work identities, with their own normalizations and time weights. The following formulas use native masses without optional mass corrections.

Face mean velocity v : cell stress.

$$Chi_k = \frac{16\pi}{3} \frac{\alpha_m \rho_k^2 \Lambda_k (w_k + w_{k+1})/2}{\Delta m_k} \frac{r_k^6 + r_{k+1}^6}{2} \left(\frac{v_k}{r_k} - \frac{v_{k+1}}{r_{k+1}} \right), \quad (8.1)$$

$$Uq_k = \frac{4\pi}{r_k^{\text{work}} \Delta m_{\text{face},k}} (Chi_{k-1} - Chi_k), \quad (8.2)$$

$$Eq_{\text{stress},k} = \frac{4\pi Chi_k}{\Delta m_k} \left(\frac{v_k^{\text{work}}}{r_k^{\text{work}}} - \frac{v_{k+1}^{\text{work}}}{r_{k+1}^{\text{work}}} \right). \quad (8.3)$$

Here $\alpha_m = \text{RSP2_alfam}$, $\Delta m_{\text{face},k} = (\Delta m_{k-1} + \Delta m_k)/2$ internally, and $\Delta m_{\text{face},1} = \Delta m_1/2$. The face energy row receives

$$Eq_{f,k} = w_k \frac{\Delta m_{k-1} (Eq/w)_{c,k-1} + \Delta m_k (Eq/w)_{c,k}}{\Delta m_{k-1} + \Delta m_k}. \quad (8.4)$$

Here $(Eq/w)_c$ is evaluated from the stress coefficient before multiplying by $(w_k + w_{k+1})/2$. This division is analytic, including at zero w . The gas row uses the direct cell stress heating $Eq_{c,k} = Eq_{\text{stress},k}$, as in TDC. Its mass integral equals the face heating integral. This preserves the cell heating stencil; projecting face heating back into cells would unnecessarily introduce a second inner neighbor. The stress uses current geometry and velocity; the force and work use the native optional time centered radii. The exterior stress is zero.

Cell mean velocity u : face stress.

$$Chi_{f,k} = \frac{16\pi}{3} \frac{\alpha_m \rho_{f,k}^2 r_k^6 \Lambda_{f,k} w_k}{\Delta m_{\text{face},k}} \left(\frac{u_{k-1}}{r_{\text{mid,start},k-1}} - \frac{u_k}{r_{\text{mid,start},k}} \right), \quad (8.5)$$

$$\Delta m_k Uq_k = \frac{4\pi}{r_{\text{mid,start},k}} (Chi_{f,k} - Chi_{f,k+1}), \quad (8.6)$$

$$Eq_{f,k} = \frac{4\pi Chi_{f,k}}{\Delta m_{\text{face},k}} \left(\frac{u_{k-1}^{\text{work}}}{r_{\text{mid,start},k-1}} - \frac{u_k^{\text{work}}}{r_{\text{mid,start},k}} \right), \quad (8.7)$$

$$Eq_k = \frac{1}{2} (Eq_{f,k} + Eq_{f,k+1}). \quad (8.8)$$

The density is the native viscosity face density and w_k is local to that face. `compute_Uq_dm_cell` returns force: the momentum row divides by Δm_k once. The half sum of face *specific* heating is essential. On an unequal mesh, weighting each cell by Δm_k allocates each face's full dual mass to that face heating.

For flux work, the work velocities are always $\bar{v} = (v + v_{\text{start}})/2$ or $\bar{u} = (u + u_{\text{start}})/2$. For local work they are averaged only when velocity time centering is on; otherwise they are current velocities. With the same stress in force and heating, summation by parts gives

$$\sum_k \Delta m_{\text{face},k} v_k^{\text{work}} U q_k + \sum_k \Delta m_k E q_k = \text{boundary stress power}, \quad v \text{ grid}, \quad (8.9)$$

$$\sum_k \Delta m_k u_k^{\text{work}} U q_k + \sum_k \Delta m_k E q_k = \text{boundary stress power}, \quad u \text{ grid}. \quad (8.10)$$

The boundary power is zero for zero boundary stress or velocity. An excised inner boundary can retain the native optional stress and its half cell mass. Its dissipated power enters the last evolved face volume; the prescribed inner face retains zero turbulent energy. Forced regions mask stress while retaining its divergence at the interface. A full center uses the zero stress limit.

For a static background, δChi contains the perturbed velocity strain times the background coefficient; $\delta U q$ stays in momentum. $E q$ and $v U q$ are second order, so they add no first order heating row. Conservative inner-face work can depend on zone $k + 2$: the $v U q$ term reaches the next cell stress, and turbulent-pressure flux work can reach w_{k+2} through the next cell pressure. The gas row retains these partials. The ordinary block tridiagonal solver is used when they vanish. Otherwise the banded matrix stores them directly or the block cyclic solver groups adjacent zone pairs. Direct cell heating remains compact. With `u_flag`, the Riemann contact pressure and velocity also depend on the inner cell turbulent pressure. Their $k + 2$ terms are retained in momentum and in both work forms. For `v_flag`, local pressure work retains the ordinary three-zone stencil.

9 Scales and the zero turbulence boundary

The independent luminosity equation uses a fixed accepted state scale,

$$L_{\text{scale},f} = \max \left(1 \text{ erg s}^{-1}, |L_{f,\text{start}}|, 10^{-3} \max_j |L_{j,\text{start}}| \right). \quad (9.1)$$

At initialization, the current state supplies this scale until an accepted start state exists. Moment row and column scales use the same luminosity reference and accepted face geometry and EOS:

$$\Pi_{\text{ref},f} = \frac{L_{\text{scale},f}}{\mathcal{A}_f \rho_f T_f}, \quad v_{\text{ref},f} = \left(\frac{L_{\text{scale},f}}{\mathcal{A}_f \rho_f} \right)^{1/3}, \quad (9.2)$$

$$\Pi_{\text{scale},f} = \max(|\Pi_{f,\text{start}}|, \Pi_{\text{ref},f}), \quad \Phi_{\text{scale},f} = \max \left(\Phi_{f,\text{start}}, \frac{3}{2} \frac{\Pi_{\text{ref},f}^2}{v_{\text{ref},f}^2} \right). \quad (9.3)$$

These are numerical normalizations, not bounds on heat transport. They are not differentiated as changing physics during a Newton solve. The new correction weights are reciprocal to the larger of the scale and the current variable magnitude. The signed Y correction weight remains $1/(1 + |Y|)$; it neither changes sign nor caps Y .

In the three equation model, at positive w , the normalized energy row is

$$R_w = \frac{\text{energy_eqn_scal}}{\Delta t} \begin{cases} c_s [R_E/w]_{\text{analytic}}, & 0 < w < c_s, \\ R_E, & w \geq c_s. \end{cases} \quad (9.4)$$

This equals $\max(1, c_s/w) R_E \text{energy_eqn_scal}/\Delta t$ at positive w . The one-equation RSP2 model retains the original normalized energy residual for nonzero accepted energy. This rescaling preserves the physical energy balance and does not weaken its residual tolerance. Crucially, the code cancels known factors *before* differentiation; it does not divide an assembled R_E .

What cancels. The storage and local sinks give

$$\frac{w^2 - w_{\text{start}}^2}{w} = w - \frac{w_{\text{start}}^2}{w}, \quad \partial_w \left(w - \frac{w_{\text{start}}^2}{w} \right) = 1 + \left(\frac{w_{\text{start}}}{w} \right)^2, \quad (9.5)$$

$$\frac{D}{w} = \frac{C_D w^2}{\Lambda}, \quad \frac{D_r}{w} = \frac{w}{\tau_{\text{rad}}}. \quad (9.6)$$

Here $C_D = (8/3)\sqrt{2/3} \text{RSP2_alfad}$; $D_r = 0$ in the three equation mode. RSP3 instead has S_f/w_f proportional to Π_f/w_f ; there is no extra numerator w to cancel in this independent covariance. For each remaining quotient, evaluate $q = x/w$ and then $\delta q = (\delta x - q \delta w)/w$, avoiding an explicit $1/w^2$. No physical coefficient is frozen.

The complete divided balance. For positive w the code evaluates the same residual as

$$\frac{R_{E,f}}{w_f} = w_f - \frac{w_{f,0}^2}{w_f} + \frac{W_f}{w_f} + \Delta t \left[\frac{D_m L_{t,c}}{w_f} - \frac{S_f}{w_f} + \frac{D_f + D_{r,f}}{w_f} - \frac{Eq_f}{w_f} \right]. \quad (9.7)$$

In W_f/w_f , the current w_f^2 in equation (2.1) is replaced by w before differentiation. The accepted $w_{f,0}^2/w_f$ term remains. The face viscous heating has a common factor w on both velocity grids; `compute_Eq_div_w_face` evaluates its regular coefficient. The physical center transport generally has no such factor and is divided with its accepted/current weights and all derivatives intact.

The zero state. For one-equation RSP2 with zero accepted energy, zero source seed and $\alpha_t = 0$, the local energy balance has a common factor w on either velocity grid. The code selects

$$\frac{c_s \text{ energy_eqn_scal}_f}{\Delta t} \min(w_f, [R_{E,f}/w_f]_{\text{analytic}}) = 0. \quad (9.8)$$

The dormant branch wins equality. No small denominator is inserted. RSP3 retains its independent Π source and does not use this factorization. At $w = e_{t,0} = R_E = 0$ the regular dormant constraint is used; finite incoming energy instead requires a positive predictor before solving the physical row.

Accepted w and Φ are nonnegative; Π remains signed. An active RSP3 positive w correction retains at least one tenth of its current value. The predictor uses two directional sweeps and the full source, dissipation, viscosity, transport and pressure work balance. Surviving Φ at negligible w supplies the local trial estimate $w = \Delta t | \left(-\frac{\partial_r P}{\rho} \right)_f \chi_T / (\chi_\rho C_P) | \sqrt{\Phi_f}$ and its Π increment. Accepted state and time weights stay fixed. This is an initial guess, not a proof of closure realizability or timestep stability.

10 Initialization, lengths and mesh state

Enabling the mode. The internal flag records the loaded layout. Enabling the mode adds Π, Φ after Y , preserves the other hydro variables and initializes missing moments. Compute the target neutral reference before assigning and unpacking

$$Y_{f,0} = \nabla_{T,f,\text{old}} - \nabla_{L,f,\text{new}}. \quad (10.1)$$

For an unforced face with positive entropy driving $-\partial s/\partial r > 0$, positive old convective luminosity and positive face energy, the missing moments are initialized as

$$\Pi_{f,0} = \frac{L_{c,f,\text{old}}}{\mathcal{A}_f \rho_f T_f}, \quad \Phi_{f,0} = \frac{3\Pi_{f,0}^2}{2e_{t,f}}. \quad (10.2)$$

These faces retain their heat flux with a fully correlated parcel variance. Other faces start with $\Pi = \Phi = 0$, retaining face turbulent energy. This changes their imported flux and avoids inferring finite variance from tiny inherited velocities in stable layers. The entropy gradient generates moments when turbulent energy is present. This initial state does not imply moment equilibrium. Retained nonzero flux at zero face energy is rejected. Surface Y is reset to zero.

Conversion sets current and accepted moments consistently and invalidates unavailable earlier generations. It precedes step snapshots and bypasses existing three equation restarts, Newton iterations and retries. Accepted moments use the native `xh_start` state.

Boundary and dormant rows. Moments vanish at the surface and mathematical inner face $N + 1$. Outer forced cells also constrain their inner bounding face. The last stored face N is active unless the inner forced region includes it. Zero mixing length and the selected forced regions use the same mask for w , Π and Φ . Their rows are

$$R_{\Pi,f} = \Pi_f / \Pi_{\text{scale},f} = 0, \quad R_{\Phi,f} = \Phi_f / \Phi_{\text{scale},f} = 0. \quad (10.3)$$

A face with local energy and current and accepted moments zero also uses this branch. Nonzero local energy or moments retain their evolution rows.

Public TDC length functions. RSP2 calls `get_TDC_Hp_face`, `get_TDC_mixing_length_face` and `get_TDC_mixing_length_cell`. The lengths are analytic. Cell lengths use the cell EOS and gravity averaged over bounding faces. For the HSE choice,

$$H_{P,k} = \frac{P_k}{\rho_k(g_k + g_{k+1})/2}, \quad \Lambda_{0,k} = \alpha_{\text{MLT}} H_{P,k}. \quad (10.4)$$

The shared harmonic option evaluates $\Lambda_k = (\Lambda_{0,k}^{-1} + (\beta_h r_k^{\text{cell}})^{-1})^{-1}$ when $\beta_h > 0$, with the native cell radius. The same helpers support the other length choices and face reconstruction.

Moment remapping. Normal remesh, envelope remesh and each split/merge operation call `hydro_rsp2:remap_rsp2`. They integrate the same positive piecewise constant overlap weights for (w^2, Π, Φ) over face control volumes, then recover w by a square root. This conserves all three mass integrals and preserves the covariance bound if the donor moments satisfy it. It does not repair a donor state that already violates that bound. Integrals landing in prescribed zero boundary volumes are transferred together to the nearest active face. With no active receiver a nonzero moment state is rejected. Quadruple precision mass coordinates protect small overlap widths. Gas internal energy keeps its separate conservative remap; face Y uses monotonic point interpolation, with linear interpolation for a new split face.

Photos at version 22 and model files with the face-w format bit store this layout. Older RSP2/RSP3 cell-w photos and models are rejected. There is no backward conversion mode.

The ordinary RSP2 thermal remap reconstructs cell averages with the native monotonic polynomials. With `mesh_adjust_get_T_from_E` false it integrates $\ln T$; with the control true it integrates specific internal energy and uses the existing EOS inversion and optional gravitational and kinetic energy correction. That correction uses the same polynomial reconstruction of old specific gravitational plus kinetic energy; its existing relative cap is retained. The polynomial constant retains the old cell average after curvature limiting. At an excised inner boundary the last cell uses a one-sided slope; the actual center retains zero slope. The energy slope is bounded to keep its endpoint values nonnegative. Temperature remapping does not itself conserve internal energy.

Saved models also use bit 17 and Pi/Phi columns for RSP3. Retries and same-layout photos use the generic hydro state machinery.

11 Linear nonadiabatic operator and physical limits

The radial LNA system is

$$\mathbf{A} \delta \mathbf{x} = \sigma \mathbf{B} \delta \mathbf{x}. \quad (11.1)$$

The RSP2 variables w, Y are supplemented by face Π, Φ . Each active moment has unit diagonal inertia in $\mathbf{B}$. The corresponding $\mathbf{A}$ row is the AD derivative of the continuous right hand side in Equations (3.1) and (4.1). No finite timestep, Newton scale or predictor enters this operator. The entropy mapping uses instantaneous coefficients, including dynamic gradL when selected.

The turbulent energy row is the continuous linearization of equation (2.2). The luminosity row includes $\delta L_c = \delta(\mathcal{A}\rho T\Pi)$. The chosen frozen convective flux option instead holds that luminosity perturbation fixed, while retaining the moment equations. The two cases therefore define different operators.

Forced or fully dormant moment rows impose $\delta\Pi = \delta\Phi = 0$ with zero inertia. A fully dormant face similarly uses $\delta w = 0$. At zero represented face energy, including underflow of w^2 , a local row without a source seed or kinetic transport also uses this constraint when $S_k/w_k \leq 0$. The source ratio is evaluated in its factored form. This is the zero branch of $\min(w_k, R_{E,k}/w_k) = 0$ at a static background; it uses current energy, not accepted timestep history. Positive driving or nonlocal coupling retains the physical energy row. A face with finite turbulent energy retains its dynamic moment rows. Active moments at exactly zero face energy have no regular linearization in these variables; LNA reports an error for that background. This is a linearization of the selected dormant branch and does not describe spontaneous onset from an exactly empty turbulent state. A temperature selected LNA cut retains the original physical masks; it does not create an extra forced moment boundary.

On a static background, pressure work retains the background pressure times the perturbed face volume flux. For `dedt` with flux work, $\delta K = 0$ but δE_{grav} remains. For local work and `eps_grav`, mechanical inertia is absent. The first order viscous force remains while $\delta E_q = 0$. These distinctions are detailed for all supported hydro branches in the companion [star LNA manuscript](#).

Equilibrium and diagnostics. LNA assumes a stationary background of the selected equations. Enabling the mode with the prescribed initial moments does not establish that condition. Setup reports the dimensional maxima of $|\dot{\Pi}_f|$ and $|\dot{\Phi}_f|$, so a residual thermal moment drift is visible before interpreting growth rates. The eigenfunction output includes real and imaginary Pi/Phi components. Profiles expose `Pi`, `Phi` and `Pi_covariance_excess`.

What the three equations do not enforce. For an isotropic velocity covariance, a realizable set of moments satisfies

$$\Pi_f^2 \leq \langle v_r'^2 \rangle_f \Phi_f = \frac{2}{3} e_{t,f} \Phi_f. \quad (11.2)$$

The local closure implemented here does not guarantee this bound under all driving histories. Non-negative Φ alone is insufficient. The coupled Pi remap and kinetic energy transport without moment transport do not establish it either. The profile diagnostic reports

$$\text{Pi_covariance_excess} = \Pi_f^2 - \frac{2}{3} e_{t,f} \Phi_f; \quad (11.3)$$

positive values indicate violation. This diagnostic imposes no flux cap.

The local entropy closure follows Flaskamp and Braun et al. [2, 1]; Kupka et al. [3] describe the nonlocal framework. RSP2 retains kinetic energy transport but omits entropy moment transport. Moment memory permits delayed or countergradient heat flux. It does not guarantee numerical stability, covariance realizability or a stellar calibration.

12 Source map

Paths below are relative to the MESA repository. This map identifies the implementation of the equations and state transitions described above.

Responsibility	Source and principal entry points
Controls and constants	<code>star/defaults/controls_dev.defaults</code> ; <code>star/private/hydro_rsp2.f90</code> : <code>x_ALFAPI</code> , <code>x_ALFAPHI</code> .
Energy and moment rows	<code>star/private/hydro_rsp2.f90</code> : <code>do1_turbulent_energy_eqn</code> , <code>do1_rsp2_moment_eqns</code> , <code>rsp2_moment_rhs</code> , <code>rsp2_moment_source</code> , <code>compute_Lt_center</code> ; <code>star_utils:calc_Ptrb_work_face</code> .
Face EOS and gradients	<code>star/private/hydro_gradient_support.f90</code> : <code>get_rsp2_face_eos</code> , <code>get_rsp2_thermal_gradient</code> , <code>get_rsp2_Lrad_coeff</code> , <code>get_dPrad_dm_factors</code> .
Hydro temperature and energy	<code>star/private/hydro_temperature.f90</code> ; <code>star/private/hydro_energy.f90</code> .
Lengths and viscosity	<code>star/private/tdc_hydro.f90</code> : public face and cell length functions; <code>star/private/hydro_rsp2.f90</code> : <code>compute_Chi_cell</code> , <code>compute_Chi_face</code> , <code>compute_Eq_cell</code> , <code>compute_Uq_face</code> , <code>compute_Uq_dm_cell</code> .
Scales and trial state	<code>star/private/hydro_rsp2.f90</code> : <code>set_etrb_start_vars</code> , <code>RSP2_adjust_vars_before_call_solver</code> ; <code>star/private/solver_support.f90</code> .
Mode conversion	<code>star/private/set_flags.f90</code> : <code>set_RSP2_3equation_flag</code> ; <code>star/private/hydro_rsp2.f90</code> : <code>init_rsp2_moments</code> .
Mesh and saved state	<code>star/private/hydro_rsp2.f90</code> : <code>remap_rsp2</code> ; <code>star/private/mesh_adjust.f90</code> , <code>star/private/adjust_mesh_split_merge.f90</code> , <code>star/private/struct_burn_mix.f90</code> , <code>star/private/read_model.f90</code> , <code>star/private/write_model.f90</code> , <code>star/private/photo_in.f90</code> , <code>star/private/photo_out.f90</code> .
LNA and output	<code>star/private/star_LNA_support.f90</code> , <code>star/private/star_LNA_turbulence_closures.f90</code> , <code>star/private/profile_getval.f90</code> .

Equation dispatch is in `star/private/hydro_eqns.f90`; the stored fields and layout are in `star_data/public/`. No independent RSP3 state store bypasses the normal MESA solver.

References

- [1] Braun, T. A. M., Ahlborn, F., Kupka, F. and Weiss, A. (2026). *Testing the 3-equation Kuhfuss Convection Model using the Sun*. [arXiv:2604.06151v1](https://arxiv.org/abs/2604.06151v1). Section 2 gives local and nonlocal closures and their normalization; Table 1 gives the solar calibrations.
- [2] Flaskamp, M. (2003). *Nichtlokale und zeitabhängige Konvektion in Sternen*. Doctoral thesis, Technische Universität München. [Thesis](#). Chapter 3 develops the entropy moment formulation.
- [3] Kupka, F., Ahlborn, F. and Weiss, A. (2022). *Astronomy & Astrophysics*, doi:10.1051/0004-6361/202243125. Appendix A gives the three equation Kuhfuss formulation.